Scale Exercises - Section II, Level 18

Major Scale Diatonic Thirds: Two-Octave Six-String Neck Ladder

26 pairs. 52 notes. One interval line.

Leave stepwise scale motion: skip one degree, roll back one, and connect every third before shifting.

1. Skip, then roll back

Play 1-3, then begin the next pair on 2. The line climbs by thirds while returning one degree between pairs.

2. Hear both third qualities

The major scale produces both major thirds and minor thirds. Name or sing the quality instead of hearing isolated frets.

3. Shift only after note 52

Finish the descending 3-1 pair, release pressure, and move the complete hand-and-thumb frame exactly one fret.

Worked example - A major at low-E fret 5

Scale tones: A B C# D E F# G# A B C# D E F# G# A. The high root repeats at the turn.

UP: 1-3 | 2-4 | ... | 13-15 DOWN: 15-13 | 14-12 | ... | 3-1

ASCENDING - 13 PAIRS / 26 NOTES

```
Int|M3----|m3----|m3----|M3----|M3----|m3----|m3----|M3----|m3----|m3----|M3----|M3----|m3----|m3----|
Deg|1--3--|2--4--|3--5--|4--6--|5--7--|6--8--|7--9--|8--10-|9--11-|10-12-|11-13-|12-14-|13-15-|
Fng|2--1--|4--2--|1--4--|2--1--|4--3--|1--4--|3--1--|4--3--|1--4--|3--2--|4--4--|2--1--|4--2--|
e  |------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|---4--|---5--|
B  |------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|---5--|---7--|5-----|7-----|
G  |------|------|------|------|------|------|---4--|---6--|4--7--|6-----|7-----|------|------|
D  |------|------|------|---4--|---6--|4--7--|6-----|7-----|------|------|------|------|------|
A  |---4--|---5--|4--7--|5-----|7-----|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
E  |5-----|7-----|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
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DESCENDING - 13 PAIRS / 26 NOTES

```
Int|m3----|M3----|M3----|m3----|m3----|M3----|m3----|m3----|m3----|M3----|M3----|m3----|m3----|M3----|
Deg|15-13-|14-12-|13-11-|12-10-|11-9--|10-8--|9--7--|8--6--|7--5--|6--4--|5--3--|4--2--|3--1--|
Fng|2--4--|1--2--|4--4--|2--3--|4--1--|3--4--|1--3--|4--1--|3--4--|1--2--|4--1--|2--4--|1--2--|
e  |5-----|4-----|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
B  |---7--|---5--|7-----|5-----|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
G  |------|------|---7--|---6--|7--4--|6-----|4-----|------|------|------|------|------|------|
D  |------|------|------|------|------|---7--|---6--|7--4--|6-----|4-----|------|------|------|
A  |------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|---7--|---5--|7--4--|5-----|4-----|
E  |------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|---7--|---5--|
```

KEY ROUTE A -> Bb -> B -> C -> Db -> D -> Eb -> E -> F -> Gb -> G -> Ab -> A, then reverse.

AUDIT Hear the third, the one-degree rollback, every crossing, the repeated high root, and the one-fret shift.

Session protocol

1. A major: first-octave pairs only.
2. Complete all 13 ascending pairs.
3. Complete all 13 descending pairs.
4. Link the high-root turn without resetting.
5. Use 2-3 neighboring rungs; pause only after each cell.
6. Connect the full route with both pick starts.

Level 18 - Chromatic Major-Key Route and Diatonic-Third Map

Ascending route: complete one 52-note thirds cell, then move the frame +1 fret

Descending route: use the same cards in reverse order and move -1 fret

Rung	Key	Low-E root	Frame	Scale tones (degrees 1-7)
01	A major	fret 5	4-7	A B C# D E F# G#
02	Bb major	fret 6	5-8	Bb C D Eb F G A
03	B major	fret 7	6-9	B C# D# E F# G# A#
04	C major	fret 8	7-10	C D E F G A B
05	Db major	fret 9	8-11	Db Eb F Gb Ab Bb C
06	D major	fret 10	9-12	D E F# G A B C#
07	Eb major	fret 11	10-13	Eb F G Ab Bb C D
08	E major	fret 12	11-14	E F# G# A B C# D#
09	F major	fret 13	12-15	F G A Bb C D E
10	Gb major	fret 14	13-16	Gb Ab Bb Cb Db Eb F
11	G major	fret 15	14-17	G A B C D E F#
12	Ab major	fret 16	15-18	Ab Bb C Db Eb F G
13	A major - octave	fret 17	16-19	A B C# D E F# G#

How to use the map

Up pass:

rungs 01-13.

Turn:

complete the high-A cell at fret 17, then reverse.

Down pass:

rungs 12-01. Do not replay rung 13 unless beginning a new round.

Learning pulse:

one two-note pair per beat as eighth notes.

Performance pulse:

two pairs per beat as sixteenth notes.

Goal:

hear one connected line of thirds, not 26 unrelated fragments.

Sequence anatomy

```
UP:   01-03 | 02-04 | 03-05 | 04-06 | 05-07 | 06-08 | 07-09 | 08-10 | 09-11 | 10-12 | 11-13 | 12-14 | 13-15

DOWN: 15-13 | 14-12 | 13-11 | 12-10 | 11-09 | 10-08 | 09-07 | 08-06 | 07-05 | 06-04 | 05-03 | 04-02 | 03-01

UP QUALITY:      M3 | m3 | m3 | M3 | M3 | m3 | m3 | M3 | m3 | m3 | M3 | M3 | m3
```

Mastery gate

Name every key, preserve the two-note pulse, hear major versus minor thirds, shift silently, and complete both pick starts on separate days.

Level 18 - Major Scale Diatonic Thirds: Two Octaves

Rungs 01-02: play each card as one 26-pair cell, then move +1 fret

For the descending pass, read the cards in reverse order and move -1 fret

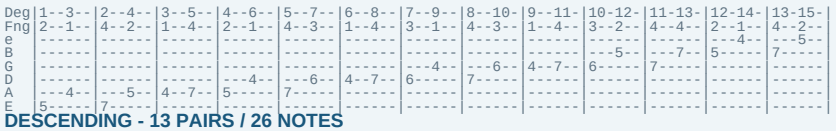
01 A MAJOR

ROOT E5 | FRAME 4-7

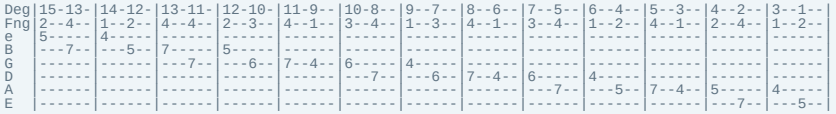
Scale tones: A B C# D E F# G# A B C# D E F# G# A

52 NOTES / 26 PAIRS

ASCENDING - 13 PAIRS / 26 NOTES



DESCENDING - 13 PAIRS / 26 NOTES



Return to the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

Pair pulse: D-U or U-D; do not reset

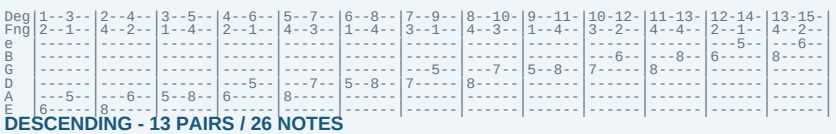
02 Bb MAJOR

ROOT E6 | FRAME 5-8

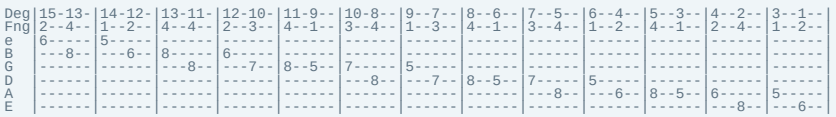
Scale tones: Bb C D Eb F G A Bb C D Eb F G A Bb

52 NOTES / 26 PAIRS

ASCENDING - 13 PAIRS / 26 NOTES



DESCENDING - 13 PAIRS / 26 NOTES



Return to the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

Pair pulse: D-U or U-D; do not reset

One pair per beat while learning; two pairs per beat as sixteenth notes after the sequence is secure.

Level 18 - Major Scale Diatonic Thirds: Two Octaves

Rungs 03-04: play each card as one 26-pair cell, then move +1 fret

For the descending pass, read the cards in reverse order and move -1 fret

03 B MAJOR

ROOT E7 | FRAME 6-9

Scale tones: B C# D# E F# G# A# B C# D# E F# G# A# B

52 NOTES / 26 PAIRS

ASCENDING - 13 PAIRS / 26 NOTES

```
Deg|1--3--|2--4--|3--5--|4--6--|5--7--|6--8--|7--9--|8--10-|9--11-|10-12-|11-13-|12-14-|13-15-|
Fng|2--1--|4--2--|1--4--|2--1--|4--3--|1--4--|3--1--|4--3--|1--4--|3--2--|4--4--|2--1--|4--2--|
e  |------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|---6--|---7--|
B  |------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|---7--|---9--|7-----|9-----|
G  |------|------|------|------|------|------|---6--|---8--|6--9--|8-----|9-----|------|------|
D  |------|------|------|---6--|---8--|6--9--|8-----|9-----|------|------|------|------|------|
A  |---6--|---7--|6--9--|7-----|9-----|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
E  |7-----|9-----|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
```

DESCENDING - 13 PAIRS / 26 NOTES

```
Deg|15-13-|14-12-|13-11-|12-10-|11-9--|10-8--|9--7--|8--6--|7--5--|6--4--|5--3--|4--2--|3--1--|
Fng|2--4--|1--2--|4--4--|2--3--|4--1--|3--4--|1--3--|4--1--|3--4--|1--2--|4--1--|2--4--|1--2--|
e  |7-----|6-----|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
B  |---9--|---7--|9-----|7-----|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
G  |------|------|---9--|---8--|9--6--|8-----|6-----|------|------|------|------|------|------|
D  |------|------|------|------|------|---9--|---8--|9--6--|8-----|6-----|------|------|------|
A  |------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|---9--|---7--|9--6--|7-----|6-----|
E  |------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|---9--|---7--|
```

Return to the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

Pair pulse: D-U or U-D; do not reset

04 C MAJOR

ROOT E8 | FRAME 7-10

Scale tones: C D E F G A B C D E F G A B C

52 NOTES / 26 PAIRS

ASCENDING - 13 PAIRS / 26 NOTES

```
Deg|1--3--|2--4--|3--5--|4--6--|5--7--|6--8--|7--9--|8--10-|9--11-|10-12-|11-13-|12-14-|13-15-|
Fng|2--1--|4--2--|1--4--|2--1--|4--3--|1--4--|3--1--|4--3--|1--4--|3--2--|4--4--|2--1--|4--2--|
e  |------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|---7--|---8--|
B  |------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|---8--|---10-|8-----|10----|
G  |------|------|------|------|------|------|---7--|---9--|7--10-|9-----|10----|------|------|
D  |------|------|------|---7--|---9--|7--10-|9-----|10----|------|------|------|------|------|
A  |---7--|---8--|7--10-|8-----|10----|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
E  |8-----|10----|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
```

DESCENDING - 13 PAIRS / 26 NOTES

```
Deg|15-13-|14-12-|13-11-|12-10-|11-9--|10-8--|9--7--|8--6--|7--5--|6--4--|5--3--|4--2--|3--1--|
Fng|2--4--|1--2--|4--4--|2--3--|4--1--|3--4--|1--3--|4--1--|3--4--|1--2--|4--1--|2--4--|1--2--|
e  |8-----|7-----|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
B  |---10-|---8--|10----|8-----|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
G  |------|------|---10-|---9--|10-7--|9-----|7-----|------|------|------|------|------|------|
D  |------|------|------|------|------|---10-|---9--|10-7--|9-----|7-----|------|------|------|
A  |------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|---10-|---8--|10-7--|8-----|7-----|
E  |------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|---10-|---8--|
```

Return to the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

Pair pulse: D-U or U-D; do not reset

One pair per beat while learning; two pairs per beat as sixteenth notes after the sequence is secure.

Level 18 - Major Scale Diatonic Thirds: Two Octaves

Rungs 05-06: play each card as one 26-pair cell, then move +1 fret

For the descending pass, read the cards in reverse order and move -1 fret

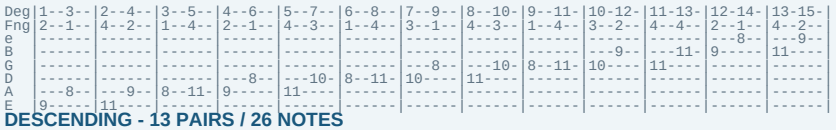
05 Db MAJOR

ROOT E9 | FRAME 8-11

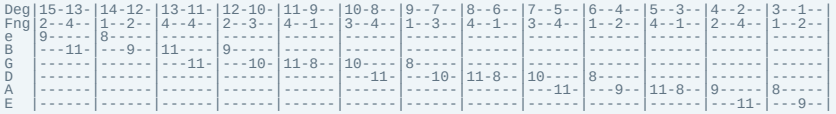
Scale tones: Db Eb F Gb Ab Bb C Db Eb F Gb Ab Bb C Db

52 NOTES / 26 PAIRS

ASCENDING - 13 PAIRS / 26 NOTES



DESCENDING - 13 PAIRS / 26 NOTES



Return to the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

Pair pulse: D-U or U-D; do not reset

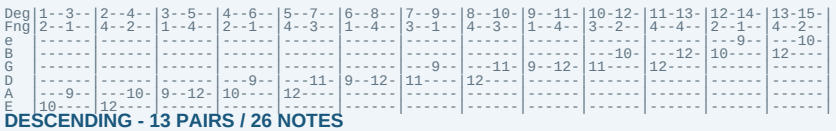
06 D MAJOR

ROOT E10 | FRAME 9-12

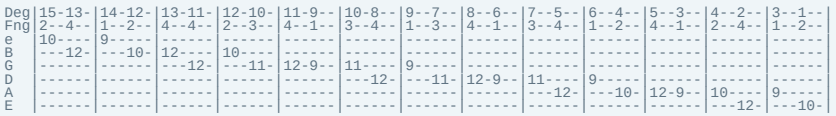
Scale tones: D E F# G A B C# D E F# G A B C# D

52 NOTES / 26 PAIRS

ASCENDING - 13 PAIRS / 26 NOTES



DESCENDING - 13 PAIRS / 26 NOTES



Return to the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

Pair pulse: D-U or U-D; do not reset

One pair per beat while learning; two pairs per beat as sixteenth notes after the sequence is secure.

Level 18 - Major Scale Diatonic Thirds: Two Octaves

Rungs 07-08: play each card as one 26-pair cell, then move +1 fret

For the descending pass, read the cards in reverse order and move -1 fret

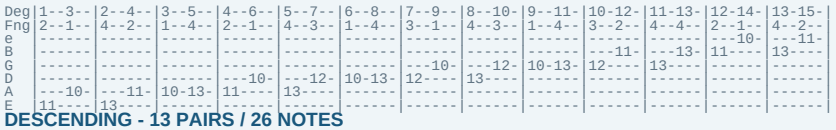
07 Eb MAJOR

ROOT E11 | FRAME 10-13

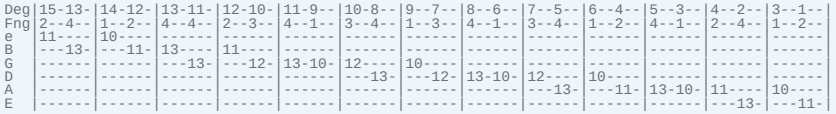
Scale tones: Eb F G Ab Bb C D Eb F G Ab Bb C D Eb

52 NOTES / 26 PAIRS

ASCENDING - 13 PAIRS / 26 NOTES



DESCENDING - 13 PAIRS / 26 NOTES



Return to the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

Pair pulse: D-U or U-D; do not reset

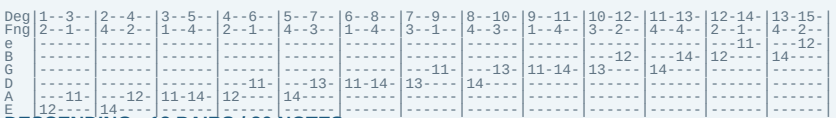
08 E MAJOR

ROOT E12 | FRAME 11-14

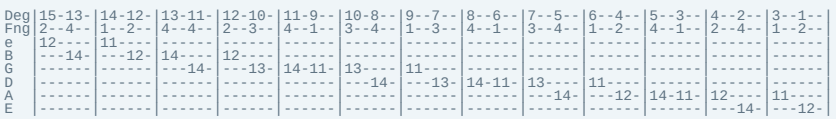
Scale tones: E F# G# A B C# D# E F# G# A B C# D# E

52 NOTES / 26 PAIRS

ASCENDING - 13 PAIRS / 26 NOTES



DESCENDING - 13 PAIRS / 26 NOTES



Return to the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

Pair pulse: D-U or U-D; do not reset

One pair per beat while learning; two pairs per beat as sixteenth notes after the sequence is secure.

Level 18 - Major Scale Diatonic Thirds: Two Octaves

Rungs 09-10: play each card as one 26-pair cell, then move +1 fret

For the descending pass, read the cards in reverse order and move -1 fret

09 F MAJOR

ROOT E13 | FRAME 12-15

Scale tones: F G A Bb C D E F G A Bb C D E F

52 NOTES / 26 PAIRS

ASCENDING - 13 PAIRS / 26 NOTES

```
Deg|1--3--|2--4--|3--5--|4--6--|5--7--|6--8--|7--9--|8--10-|9--11-|10-12-|11-13-|12-14-|13-15-|
Fng|2--1--|4--2--|1--4--|2--1--|4--3--|1--4--|3--1--|4--3--|1--4--|3--2--|4--4--|2--1--|4--2--|
e  |------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|---12-|---13-|
B  |------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|---13-|---15-|13----|15----|
G  |------|------|------|------|------|------|---12-|---14-|12-15-|14----|15----|------|------|------|
D  |------|------|------|---12-|---14-|12-15-|14----|15----|------|------|------|------|------|------|
A  |---12-|---13-|12-15-|13----|15----|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
E  |13----|15----|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
```

DESCENDING - 13 PAIRS / 26 NOTES

```
Deg|15-13-|14-12-|13-11-|12-10-|11-9--|10-8--|9--7--|8--6--|7--5--|6--4--|5--3--|4--2--|3--1--|
Fng|2--4--|1--2--|4--4--|2--3--|4--1--|3--4--|1--3--|4--1--|3--4--|1--2--|4--1--|2--4--|1--2--|
e  |13----|12----|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
B  |---15-|---13-|15----|13----|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
G  |------|------|---15-|---14-|15-12-|14----|12----|------|------|------|------|------|------|
D  |------|------|------|------|------|---15-|---14-|15-12-|14----|12----|------|------|------|
A  |------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|---15-|---13-|15-12-|13----|12----|
E  |------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|---15-|---13-|
```

Return to the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

Pair pulse: D-U or U-D; do not reset

10 Gb MAJOR

ROOT E14 | FRAME 13-16

Scale tones: Gb Ab Bb Cb Db Eb F Gb Ab Bb Cb Db Eb F Gb

52 NOTES / 26 PAIRS

ASCENDING - 13 PAIRS / 26 NOTES

```
Deg|1--3--|2--4--|3--5--|4--6--|5--7--|6--8--|7--9--|8--10-|9--11-|10-12-|11-13-|12-14-|13-15-|
Fng|2--1--|4--2--|1--4--|2--1--|4--3--|1--4--|3--1--|4--3--|1--4--|3--2--|4--4--|2--1--|4--2--|
e  |------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|---13-|---14-|
B  |------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|---14-|---16-|14----|16----|
G  |------|------|------|------|------|------|---13-|---15-|13-16-|15----|16----|------|------|------|
D  |------|------|------|---13-|---15-|13-16-|15----|16----|------|------|------|------|------|------|
A  |---13-|---14-|13-16-|14----|16----|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
E  |14----|16----|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
```

DESCENDING - 13 PAIRS / 26 NOTES

```
Deg|15-13-|14-12-|13-11-|12-10-|11-9--|10-8--|9--7--|8--6--|7--5--|6--4--|5--3--|4--2--|3--1--|
Fng|2--4--|1--2--|4--4--|2--3--|4--1--|3--4--|1--3--|4--1--|3--4--|1--2--|4--1--|2--4--|1--2--|
e  |14----|13----|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
B  |---16-|---14-|16----|14----|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
G  |------|------|---16-|---15-|16-13-|15----|13----|------|------|------|------|------|------|
D  |------|------|------|------|------|---16-|---15-|16-13-|15----|13----|------|------|------|
A  |------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|---16-|---14-|16-13-|14----|13----|
E  |------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|---16-|---14-|
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Return to the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

Pair pulse: D-U or U-D; do not reset

One pair per beat while learning; two pairs per beat as sixteenth notes after the sequence is secure.

Level 18 - Major Scale Diatonic Thirds: Two Octaves

Rungs 11-12: play each card as one 26-pair cell, then move +1 fret

For the descending pass, read the cards in reverse order and move -1 fret

11 G MAJOR

ROOT E15 | FRAME 14-17

Scale tones: G A B C D E F# G A B C D E F# G

52 NOTES / 26 PAIRS

ASCENDING - 13 PAIRS / 26 NOTES

```
Deg|1--3--|2--4--|3--5--|4--6--|5--7--|6--8--|7--9--|8--10-|9--11-|10-12-|11-13-|12-14-|13-15-|
Fng|2--1--|4--2--|1--4--|2--1--|4--3--|1--4--|3--1--|4--3--|1--4--|3--2--|4--4--|2--1--|4--2--|
e  |------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|---14-|---15-|
B  |------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|---15-|---17-|15----|17----|
G  |------|------|------|------|------|------|---14-|---16-|14-17-|16----|17----|------|------|
D  |------|------|------|---14-|---16-|14-17-|16----|17----|------|------|------|------|------|
A  |---14-|---15-|14-17-|15----|17----|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
E  |15----|17----|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
```

DESCENDING - 13 PAIRS / 26 NOTES

```
Deg|15-13-|14-12-|13-11-|12-10-|11-9--|10-8--|9--7--|8--6--|7--5--|6--4--|5--3--|4--2--|3--1--|
Fng|2--4--|1--2--|4--4--|2--3--|4--1--|3--4--|1--3--|4--1--|3--4--|1--2--|4--1--|2--4--|1--2--|
e  |15----|14----|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
B  |---17-|---15-|17----|15----|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
G  |------|------|---17-|---16-|17-14-|16----|14----|------|------|------|------|------|------|
D  |------|------|------|------|------|---17-|---16-|17-14-|16----|14----|------|------|------|
A  |------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|---17-|---15-|17-14-|15----|14----|
E  |------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|---17-|---15-|
```

Return to the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

Pair pulse: D-U or U-D; do not reset

12 Ab MAJOR

ROOT E16 | FRAME 15-18

Scale tones: Ab Bb C Db Eb F G Ab Bb C Db Eb F G Ab

52 NOTES / 26 PAIRS

ASCENDING - 13 PAIRS / 26 NOTES

```
Deg|1--3--|2--4--|3--5--|4--6--|5--7--|6--8--|7--9--|8--10-|9--11-|10-12-|11-13-|12-14-|13-15-|
Fng|2--1--|4--2--|1--4--|2--1--|4--3--|1--4--|3--1--|4--3--|1--4--|3--2--|4--4--|2--1--|4--2--|
e  |------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|---15-|---16-|
B  |------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|---16-|---18-|16----|18----|
G  |------|------|------|------|------|------|---15-|---17-|15-18-|17----|18----|------|------|
D  |------|------|------|---15-|---17-|15-18-|17----|18----|------|------|------|------|------|
A  |---15-|---16-|15-18-|16----|18----|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
E  |16----|18----|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
```

DESCENDING - 13 PAIRS / 26 NOTES

```
Deg|15-13-|14-12-|13-11-|12-10-|11-9--|10-8--|9--7--|8--6--|7--5--|6--4--|5--3--|4--2--|3--1--|
Fng|2--4--|1--2--|4--4--|2--3--|4--1--|3--4--|1--3--|4--1--|3--4--|1--2--|4--1--|2--4--|1--2--|
e  |16----|15----|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
B  |---18-|---16-|18----|16----|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
G  |------|------|---18-|---17-|18-15-|17----|15----|------|------|------|------|------|------|
D  |------|------|------|------|------|---18-|---17-|18-15-|17----|15----|------|------|------|
A  |------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|---18-|---16-|18-15-|16----|15----|
E  |------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|---18-|---16-|
```

Return to the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

Pair pulse: D-U or U-D; do not reset

One pair per beat while learning; two pairs per beat as sixteenth notes after the sequence is secure.

Level 18 - Final Rung and Full Round-Trip Challenge

Rung 13: complete the high-A thirds cell at fret 17, then reverse the neck route

Do not replay rung 13 during the down pass unless beginning a new round

13 A MAJOR - OCTAVE

ROOT E17 | FRAME 16-19

Scale tones: A B C# D E F# G# A B C# D E F# G# A

52 NOTES / 26 PAIRS

ASCENDING - 13 PAIRS / 26 NOTES

Deg	1--3--	2--4--	3--5--	4--6--	5--7--	6--8--	7--9--	8--10-	9--11-	10-12-	11-13-	12-14-	13-15-
Fng	2--1--	4--2--	1--4--	2--1--	4--3--	1--4--	3--1--	4--3--	1--4--	3--2--	4--4--	2--1--	4--2--
e	------	------	------	------	------	------	------	------	------	------	------	---16-	---17-
B	------	------	------	------	------	------	------	------	------	---17-	---19-	17----	19----
G	------	------	------	------	------	------	---16-	---18-	16-19-	18----	19----	------	------
D	------	------	------	---16-	---18-	16-19-	18----	19----	------	------	------	------	------
A	---16-	---17-	16-19-	17----	19----	------	------	------	------	------	------	------	------
E	17----	19----	------	------	------	------	------	------	------	------	------	------	------

DESCENDING - 13 PAIRS / 26 NOTES

Deg	15-13-	14-12-	13-11-	12-10-	11-9--	10-8--	9--7--	8--6--	7--5--	6--4--	5--3--	4--2--	3--1--
Fng	2--4--	1--2--	4--4--	2--3--	4--1--	3--4--	1--3--	4--1--	3--4--	1--2--	4--1--	2--4--	1--2--
e	17----	16----	------	------	------	------	------	------	------	------	------	------	------
B	---19-	---17-	19----	17----	------	------	------	------	------	------	------	------	------
G	------	------	---19-	---18-	19-16-	18----	16----	------	------	------	------	------	------
D	------	------	------	------	------	---19-	---18-	19-16-	18----	16----	------	------	------
A	------	------	------	------	------	------	------	------	---19-	---17-	19-16-	17----	16----
E	------	------	------	------	------	------	------	------	------	------	------	---19-	---17-

Return to the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

Pair pulse: D-U or U-D; do not reset

Full round-trip challenge

Start at A major on low-E fret 5. Play rungs 01-13 without restarting the pick cycle. Reverse after the fret-17 A-major cell and return through rungs 12-01. Say each key name aloud before its first low root. Repeat the complete route with the opposite starting stroke.

ROUTE COUNT	25 cells x 52 notes = 1,300 picked notes.
TEMPO RULE	Add 2 BPM after 3 clean trips; reduce 4-6 BPM after 2 errors.
PICK STARTS	Complete one D-start round and one U-start round.
EAR GOAL	Name or sing M3 versus m3 without losing the pair pulse.

Clean-round standard

- No missing, doubled, reversed, or reordered third pair.
- The one-degree rollback never causes a pause or accent.
- Correct string changes, B-string offset, and assigned fingering.
- Both articulated high-root notes are equal in volume.
- No scrape or tempo change during any one-fret shift.
- Major and minor third qualities remain audible inside one line.

The complete A-to-A-to-A route contains 25 cells and 1,300 continuously picked notes.

Level 18 - Practice Architecture, Ear Training, and Mastery Gate

Five-phase practice sequence

1. **First-octave checkpoint**
   A major: pairs 1-3 through 6-8, then reverse.
2. **Ascending half**
   A major: all 13 pairs / 26 notes. Use both pick starts.
3. **Descending half**
   A major: all 13 pairs / 26 notes. Preserve the rollback.
4. **Link the turn**
   Play all 52 notes; articulate both high-root notes without a reset.
5. **Full ladder**
   Use 2-3 neighboring keys, then climb to fret 17 and return.

Interval and crossing audit

Third quality	Hear whether each pair is M3 or m3; do not reduce it to fret distance.
Rollback	After the upper note, the next pair begins one degree lower than that upper note.
String crossing	Keep pick depth shallow and do not accent the landing string.
Middle octave	Degree 8 is part of the sequence, not a reset or breath point.
B-string offset	Use the assigned B/high-e geometry rather than copying the G-string shape.
Frame shift	Move only after note 52; release pressure before moving one fret.

After the basic ladder is clean

1. Accent the first note of every pair, then remove all pair accents.
2. Accent only the upper note of every pair without rushing the rollback.
3. Say M3 or m3 before each pair in a single selected key.
4. Play one pair per beat, then two pairs per beat at the same metronome marking.
5. Begin selected sessions at fret 17 and descend first.
6. Choose a random root fret 5-17, name the key, and continue either direction.

These are Level 18 variations, not separate full levels.

Mastery gate before Level 19

Complete the full route with a steady two-note pulse, correct interval qualities, silent one-fret shifts, and both pick starts on two separate days.

Practice log

Date _____ BPM ____ D/U ____ Clean Y/N ____

Date _____ BPM ____ D/U ____ Clean Y/N ____

Date _____ BPM ____ D/U ____ Clean Y/N ____